

Skills Summary

Adding Three-Digit Numbers with Regrouping

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Skill 1 — Adding with one regroup

Rule: Add one column at a time, starting at the ones. A column that reaches ten or more is *regrouped*: write the ones digit of that column's total and carry the ten into the next column left.

Place values: ones, tens, hundreds. Ten ones make one ten; ten tens make one hundred.

Example: Add $265 + 118$.

Step 1. The ones digits are the only pair here that can reach ten, so I expect exactly one carry and I work right to left to catch it before it is needed.

Step 2. Ones: five plus eight is thirteen, so write three and carry one ten. Tens: six plus one, plus the carried ten, is eight. Hundreds: two plus one is three.

383

Try it: Add $372 + 219$.

check: 591

Skill 2 — Adding with two regroup

Rule: A carried ten joins the next column *before* you decide whether that column regroups too.

So a second regroup can appear where the two original digits alone would not have reached ten.

Example: Add $378 + 246$.

Step 1. Both the ones and the tens look close to ten here, so I add the carry into a column first and only then ask whether that column regroups.

Step 2. Ones: eight plus six is fourteen, write four and carry. Tens: seven plus four is eleven, and the carried ten makes twelve, so write two and carry again. Hundreds: three plus two, plus the carry, is six.

624

Try it: Add $465 + 289$.

check: 754

Skill 3 — Estimating a sum, then adding

Rule: To estimate to the nearest hundred, round *each* addend first, then add the rounded numbers.

Look at the tens digit: below five rounds down, five or more rounds up.

The estimate is a check, not the answer — if the exact sum lands far from it, one of the two is wrong.

Example: Estimate $523 + 291$ to the nearest hundred, then add exactly.

Step 1. An estimate is only useful if it is quick, so I round both addends to hundreds before adding anything, and keep the exact addition as a separate second pass.

Step 2. Rounding gives five hundred and three hundred, whose sum is the estimate. Adding exactly: ones three plus one is four; tens two plus nine is eleven, write one and carry; hundreds five plus two, plus the carry, is eight.

estimate **800** exact **814**

Try it: Estimate $618 + 247$ to the nearest hundred, then add exactly.

check: estimate 800, exact 865

Skill 4 — Finding a lost carry

Rule: The commonest addition error is writing a column's whole total, or only its ones digit, and never carrying the ten.

To find it, redo the addition column by column and compare each digit — the first digit that differs is where the carry went missing.

Example: Someone added $329 + 145$ and wrote 464. What went wrong?

Step 1. A wrong sum this close to the right one usually means a single lost carry, so instead of guessing I redo the columns and stop at the first digit that disagrees.

Step 2. Ones: nine plus five is fourteen, so four is written and one ten is carried — that carry is what is missing. Tens: two plus four, plus the carried ten, is seven, not the six that was written. Hundreds: three plus one is four.

correct sum **474**

Try it: Someone added $257 + 186$ and wrote 333. Find the correct sum.

check: 443